FOSSIL FUELS & INDUSTRY · 1750–2024

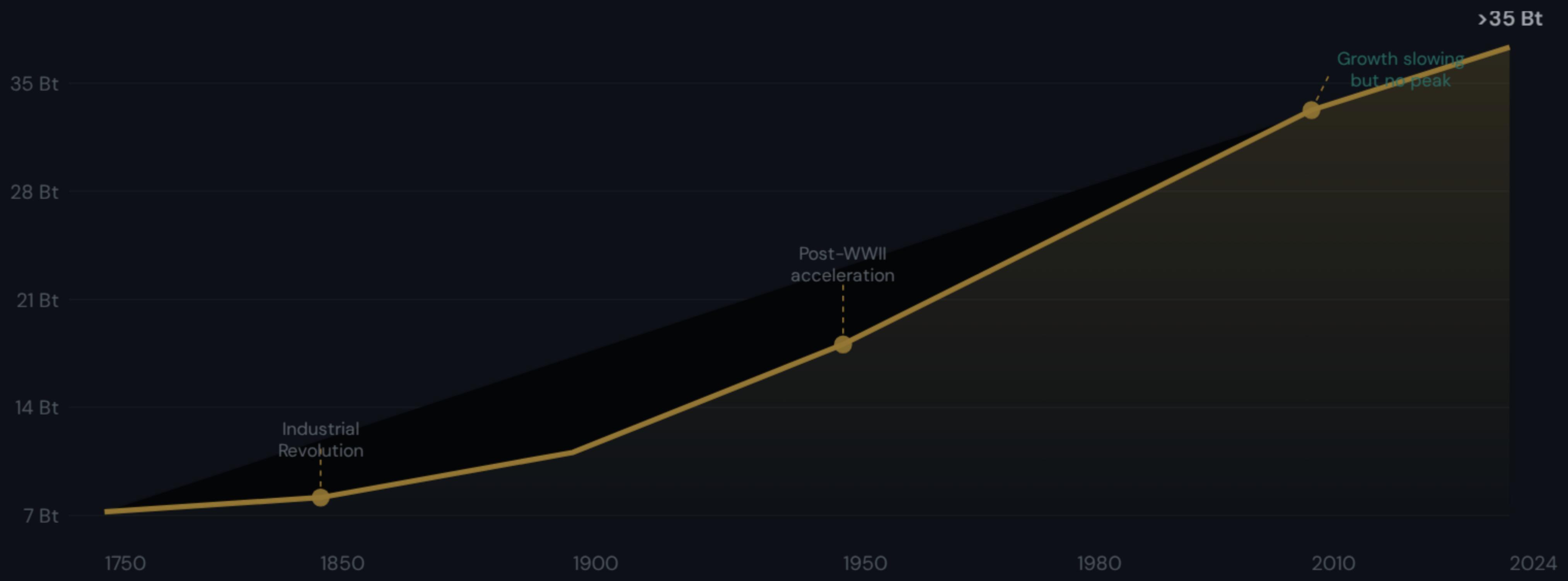
Global CO_2 Emissions

Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data
Authors: Hannah Ritchie & Max Roser

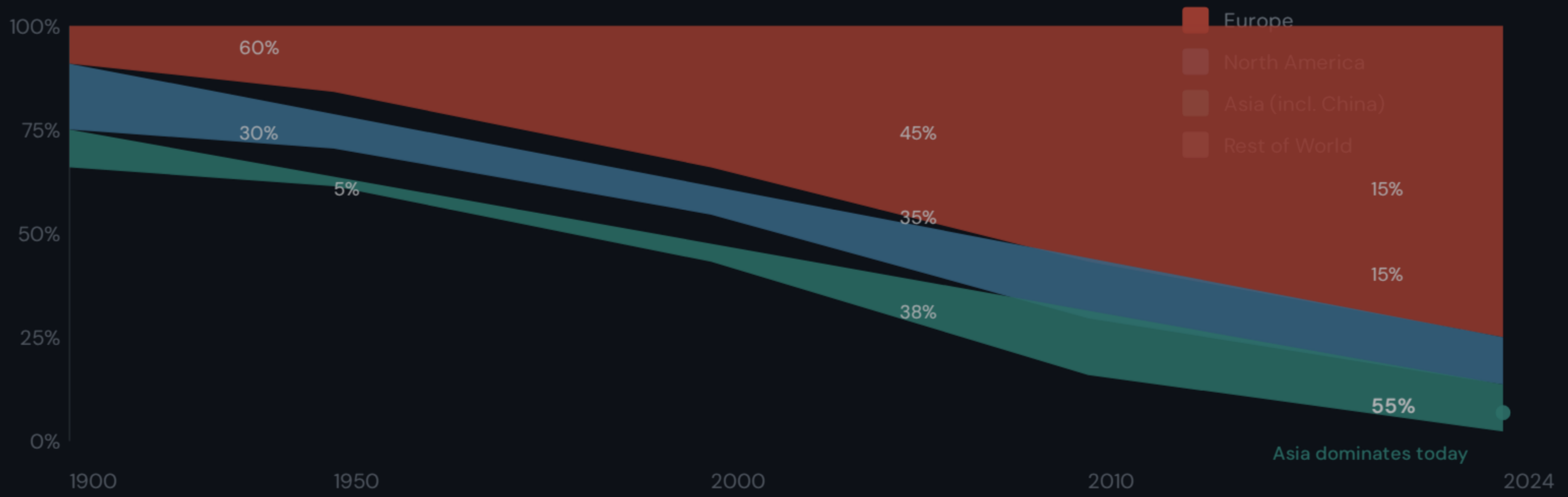
Global CO_2 Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

Long-run trajectory from the Industrial Revolution to present



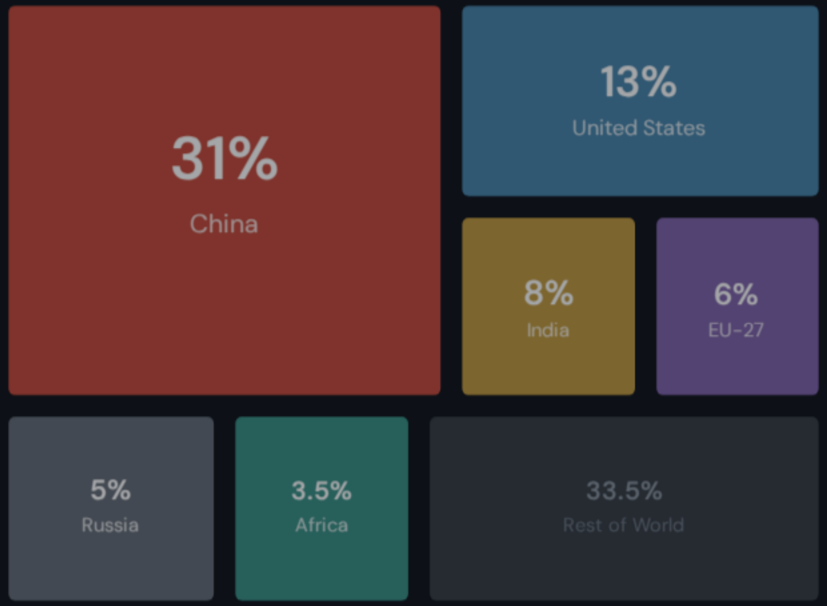
Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today

The dramatic shift in regional emission shares over two centuries



China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO_2

Country-level shares of global CO_2 emissions, 2024

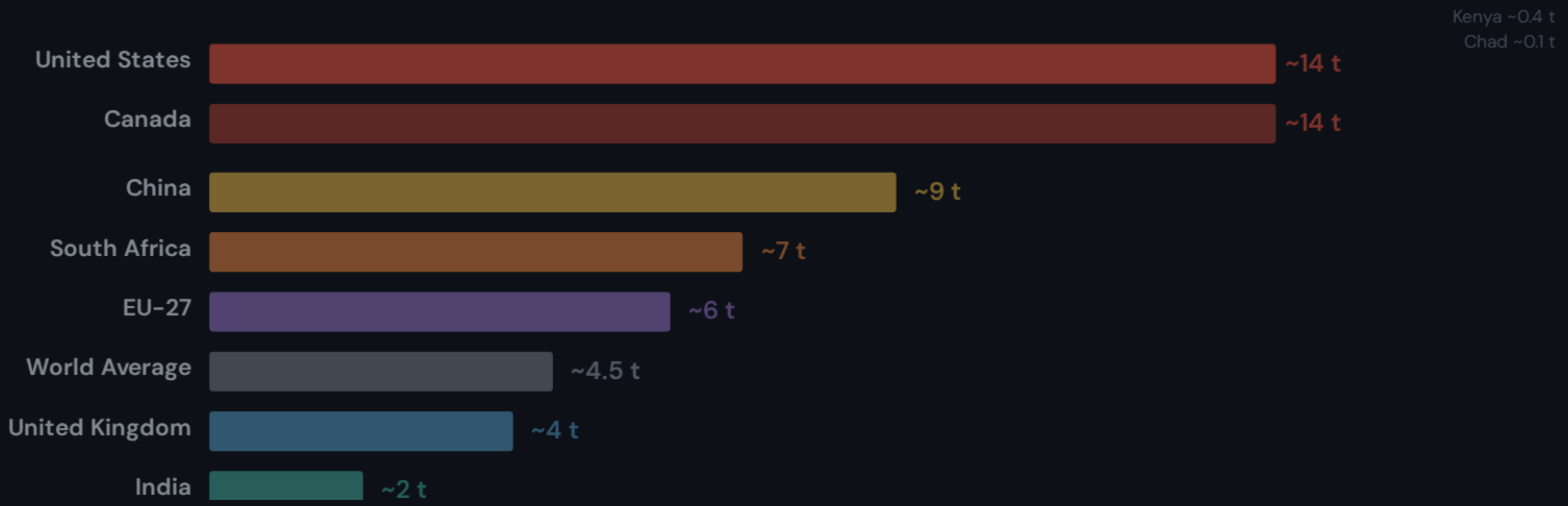


Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada

A 150x gap between the world's lowest and highest per-capita emitters

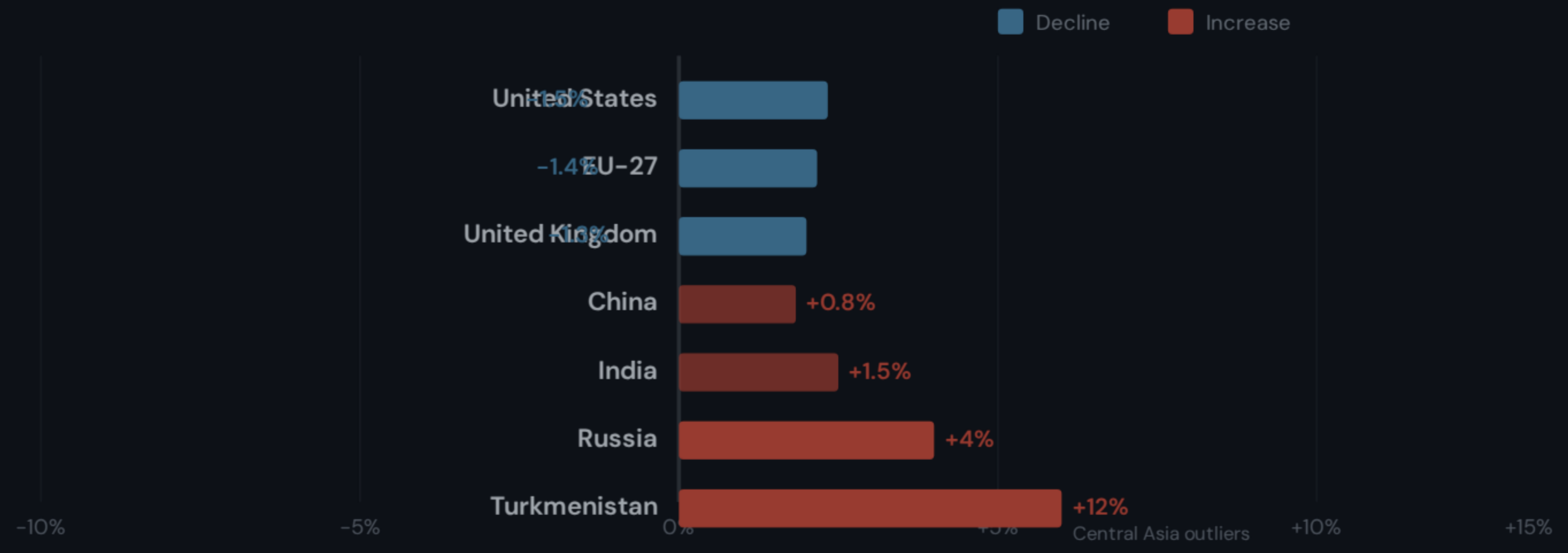
Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

Key country comparison — note China's per capita remains below the US despite being the largest total emitter



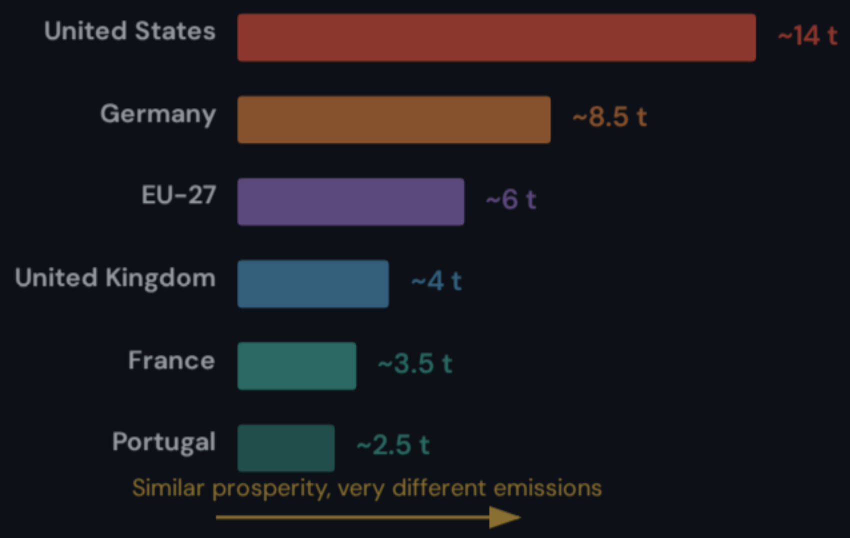
2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew

Annual percentage change in CO_2 emissions — blue indicates decline, red/orange indicates increase



Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

Among wealthy nations, energy source choices drive dramatic per-capita emission differences



Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

Five findings that should inform climate policy and responsibility debates

FINDING 1

Global CO_2 emissions exceed **35 billion tonnes per year** and have not yet peaked despite slowing growth.

FINDING 2

China is the largest annual emitter (~31%) but per capita remains below the US (~9 t vs. ~14 t).

FINDING 3

Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US — over 90% of emissions in 1900.